

● HARD

● ALGEBRA

● ANSWER KEY

Algebra

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Q1**A**

A. $P = \frac{w}{110}$

Choice A is correct. It's given that w represents the total wall area, in square feet. Since the walls of the room will be painted twice, the amount of paint, in gallons, needs to cover $2w$ square feet. It's also given that one gallon of paint will cover 220 square feet. Dividing the total area, in square feet, of the surface to be painted by the number of square feet covered by one gallon of paint gives the number of gallons of paint that will be needed. Dividing $2w$ by 220 yields $\frac{2w}{220}$, or $\frac{w}{110}$. Therefore, the equation that represents the total amount of paint P , in gallons, needed to paint the walls of the room twice is $P = \frac{w}{110}$.

Choice B is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Choice C is incorrect and may result from finding the amount of paint needed to paint the walls once rather than twice.

Choice D is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Q2**25**

The correct answer is 25. It's given that a piece of wire has a length of 32 inches and is cut into two parts. It's also given that one part has a length of x inches and the other part has a length of y inches. It follows that the equation $x + y = 32$ represents this situation. It's also given that the value of x is 4 more than 3 times the value of y , or $x = 3y + 4$. Substituting $3y + 4$ for x in the equation $x + y = 32$ yields $3y + 4 + y = 32$. Combining like terms on the left-hand side of this equation yields $4y + 4 = 32$. Subtracting 4 from both sides of this equation yields $4y = 28$. Dividing both sides of this equation by 4 yields $y = 7$. Substituting 7 for y in the equation $x = 3y + 4$ yields $x = 3(7) + 4$, or $x = 25$. Therefore, the value of x is 25.

Q3**24**

The correct answer is 24. A line in the xy -plane can be defined by the equation $y = mx + b$, where m is the slope of the line and b is the y -coordinate of the y -intercept of the line. It's given that line l passes through the point $0, 0$. Therefore, the y -coordinate of the y -intercept of line l is 0 . It's given that line l is parallel to the line represented by the equation $y = 8x + 2$. Since parallel lines have the same slope, it follows that the slope of line l is 8 . Therefore, line l can be defined by an equation in the form $y = mx + b$, where $m = 8$ and $b = 0$. Substituting 8 for m and 0 for b in $y = mx + b$ yields the equation $y = 8x + 0$, or $y = 8x$. If line l passes through the point $3, d$, then when $x = 3$, $y = d$ for the equation $y = 8x$. Substituting 3 for x and d for y in the equation $y = 8x$ yields $d = 8 \cdot 3$, or $d = 24$.

Q4**D**

- D. The increase in the length, in centimeters, of the spring for each one-newton increase in the weight of the object

Choice D is correct. The value 2 is multiplied by w , the weight of the object. When the weight is 0 , the length is $30 + 2(0) = 30$ centimeters. If the weight increases by w newtons, the length increases by $2w$ centimeters, or 2 centimeters for each one-newton increase in weight.

Choice A is incorrect because this describes the value 30 . Choice B is incorrect because 30 represents the length of the spring before it has been stretched. Choice C is incorrect because this describes the value w .

Q5**80**

The correct answer is 80. Subtracting the second equation in the given system from the first equation yields $24x + y - 6x + y = 48 - 72$, which is equivalent to $24x - 6x + y - y = -24$, or $18x = -24$. Dividing each side of this equation by 3 yields $6x = -8$. Substituting -8 for $6x$ in the second equation yields $-8 + y = 72$. Adding 8 to both sides of this equation yields $y = 80$.

Alternate approach: Multiplying each side of the second equation in the given system by 4 yields $24x + 4y = 288$. Subtracting the first equation in the given system from this equation yields $24x + 4y - 24x + y = 288 - 48$, which is equivalent to $24x - 24x + 4y - y = 240$, or $3y = 240$. Dividing each side of this equation by 3 yields $y = 80$.

Q6**D****D.** $\frac{7}{2}$

Choice D is correct. The x -coordinate a of the x -intercept $a, 0$ can be found by substituting 0 for y in the given equation, which gives $7x + 20 = -31$, or $7x = -31$. Dividing both sides of this equation by 7 yields $x = -\frac{31}{7}$. Therefore, the value of a is $-\frac{31}{7}$. The y -coordinate b of the y -intercept $0, b$ can be found by substituting 0 for x in the given equation, which gives $70 + 2y = -31$, or $2y = -31$. Dividing both sides of this equation by 2 yields $y = -\frac{31}{2}$. Therefore, the value of b is $-\frac{31}{2}$. It follows that the value of $\frac{b}{a}$ is $\frac{-\frac{31}{2}}{-\frac{31}{7}}$, which is equivalent to $\frac{31}{2} \cdot \frac{7}{31}$, or $\frac{7}{2}$.

Choice A is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Choice B is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Choice C is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Q7**D****D. 192**

Choice D is correct. The table gives that $f(x) = 0$ when $x = 2$. Substituting 0 for fx and 2 for x into the equation $f(x) = ax + b$ yields $0 = 2a + b$. Subtracting $2a$ from both sides of this equation yields $b = -2a$. The table gives that $f(x) = -64$ when $x = 1$. Substituting $-2a$ for b , -64 for fx , and 1 for x into the equation $f(x) = ax + b$ yields $-64 = a + -2a$. Combining like terms yields $-64 = -a$, or $a = 64$. Since $b = -2a$, substituting 64 for a into this equation gives $b = -128$, which yields $b = -128$. Thus, the value of $a - b$ can be written as $64 - (-128)$, which is 192.

Choice A is incorrect. This is the value of $a + b$, not $a - b$.

Choice B is incorrect. This is the value of $a - 2$, not $a - b$.

Choice C is incorrect. This is the value of $2a$, not $a - b$.

Q8**B**

B. $\frac{1}{3}x = 4y$

Choice B is correct. A system of two linear equations in two variables, x and y , has no solution when the lines in the xy -plane representing the equations are parallel and distinct. Two lines are parallel and distinct if their slopes are the same and their y -intercepts are different. The slope of the graph of the given equation, $3x = 36y - 45$, in the xy -plane can be found by rewriting the equation in the form $y = mx + b$, where m is the slope of the graph and $0, b$ is the y -intercept. Adding 45 to each side of the given equation yields $3x + 45 = 36y$. Dividing each side of this equation by 36 yields $\frac{1}{12}x + \frac{5}{4} = y$, or $y = \frac{1}{12}x + \frac{5}{4}$. It follows that the slope of the graph of the given equation is $\frac{1}{12}$ and the y -intercept is $0, \frac{5}{4}$. Therefore, the graph of the second equation in the system must also have a slope of $\frac{1}{12}$, but must not have a y -intercept of $0, \frac{5}{4}$. Multiplying each side of the equation given in choice B by $\frac{1}{4}$ yields $\frac{1}{12}x = y$, or $y = \frac{1}{12}x$. It follows that the graph representing the equation in choice B has a slope of $\frac{1}{12}$ and a y -intercept of $0, 0$. Since the slopes of the graphs of the two equations are equal and the y -intercepts of the graphs of the two equations are different, the equation in choice B could be the second equation in the system.

Choice A is incorrect. This equation can be rewritten as $y = \frac{1}{4}x$. It follows that the graph of this equation has a slope of $\frac{1}{4}$, so the system consisting of this equation and the given equation has exactly one solution, rather than no solution.

Choice C is incorrect. This equation can be rewritten as $y = \frac{1}{12}x + \frac{5}{4}$. It follows that the graph of this equation has a slope of $\frac{1}{12}$ and a y -intercept of $0, \frac{5}{4}$, so the system consisting of this equation and the given equation has infinitely many solutions, rather than no solution.

Choice D is incorrect. This equation can be rewritten as $y = \frac{1}{36}x + \frac{5}{4}$. It follows that the graph of this equation has a slope of $\frac{1}{36}$, so the system consisting of this equation and the given equation has exactly one solution, rather than no solution.

Q9**40**

The correct answer is 40. It's given that $5G + 45R = 380$, where G is the number of green tokens and R is the number of red tokens won by one student and these tokens are worth a total of 380 points. Since the equation represents the situation where the student won points with green tokens and red tokens for a total of 380 points, each term on the left-hand side of the equation represents the number of points won for one of the colors. Since the coefficient of G in the given equation is 5, a green token must be worth 5 points. Similarly, since the coefficient of R in the given equation is 45, a red token must be worth 45 points. Therefore, a red token is worth $45 - 5$ points, or 40 points, more than a green token.

Q10**C**

C. $f(t) = -\frac{21}{130}t + 4$

Choice C is correct. It is assumed that the oil and gas production decreased at a constant rate. Therefore, the function f that best models the production t years after the year 2000 can be written as a linear function, $f(t) = mt + b$, where m is the rate of change of the oil and gas production and b is the oil and gas production, in millions of barrels, in the year 2000. Since there were 4 million barrels of oil and gas produced in 2000, $b = 4$. The rate of change, m , can be calculated as $\frac{4 - 1.9}{0 - 13} = -\frac{2.1}{13}$, which is equivalent to $-\frac{21}{130}$, the rate of change in choice C.

Choices A and B are incorrect because each of these functions has a positive rate of change. Since the oil and gas production decreased over time, the rate of change must be negative. Choice D is incorrect. This model may result from misinterpreting 1.9 million barrels as the amount by which the production decreased.

Notes

Accept equivalent forms (e.g. $0.25 \equiv 1/4$). For grid-in items, decimal and fraction answers are both valid.

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